The Mountainside

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CDC-CMA Agreement Set for Board and Member Votes

The proposed agreement between the Coolfont Mountainside Association and Coolfont Development Corporation is being fine-tuned prior to a vote on the document by the CMA board of directors, and a vote on the acceptance of new land from the CMA membership on March 11.

The negotiation team took direction from the board at its last meeting to make additional changes in the agreement, which calls for CDC to pay our association $110,000 over a 24-month period, which will be used to help upgrade the CMA water-sewer system.

The agreement allows the development of 8 new lots to the south of CMA, in the Salmon tract owned by the Ashelmans. These new lots will range in size from about 2 to 3 acres. The agreement also settles all outstanding issues with CDC resulting from the 1986 agreement.

The agreement will be presented for final board approval at the next CMA board meeting, February 4, at 9:00 a.m. at the Davis Memorial Library in Bethesda, MD.

The issue of the impact of the new lots on water and sewer capacity was raised by several members prior to the last board meeting. The agreement was changed to call for additional money to be paid to CMA by CDC if additional capacity was found by engineering studies to be required. In addition, the new lots will be subject to CMA fees set by the board, similar to hookup and initiation fees paid by current new lot purchasers.

The question of upgrading begins with the question itself: "What exactly is broken, and what will it take to fix it?"

In the case of CMA, it has been well known for years that the water system has been in need of improvement. For example, due to leaks and other problems, the system loses as much as half the water it pumps from its wells before the water gets to the houses. In addition, multiple wells, reservoirs and pumps all raise the complexity and operating costs of a water system. Clearly, these conditions cannot continue.

For the water system, an engineering study by John Lewis and Associates proposed a single, large reservoir higher on the mountainside, which, among other improvements, will provide the height necessary to maintain good water pressure, while also simplifying the system.

For the sewer system, an aeration process has been proposed which would increase the effectiveness of the current lagoon and wetlands system, thereby increasing capacity.

But there are other infrastructure problems to face, as well.

The south Mountainside Road is in terrible condition, and despite the reprieve a mild (so far) winter has given us, this stretch of pavement clearly will need a more reliable surface. Union paving recommended a similar or better asphalt surface than the one on the north Mountainside Road.

Then there are the tennis courts, which, due to cracks and crevices, add a new and dangerous element to the sport. And our beautiful swimming pool is showing its age, with tile and surface replacement necessary in the next year or so. The finance committee has been wrestling with projected costs and financing options for these repairs and upgrades, and an important issue at the members' meeting on March 11 will be to review tand approve he committee's financing recommendations.

COOLFONT FOUNDATION PERFORMANCE SCHEDULE

Two more concerts are scheduled for the Coolfont Foundation's 1994-1995 season, both to be held at the Manor House.

The first concert of 1995 will be on Saturday, May 13, featuring Elizabeth Borowski, pianist, and Emmanuel Borowski, violinist. They will be performing with the Towson State University Cello Ensemble.

In midsummer, cellist Cecylia Barczyk will perform in the last concert of the 1994-1995 season. Her recital is scheduled for Saturday, July 1, also at the Manor House.

Please make plans to attend these special musical events. The starting times of the concerts will be announced shortly. If you have additional questions, please call Coolfont Foundation Chair Renee Jasper at (301) 229-0644.

Don't Forget!

Next CMA Board Meeting:

9:00 a.m.
Saturday, February 4, 1995

Davis Memorial Library
6400 Democracy Blvd.
Bethesda, MD

MOUNTAINSIDE SECRETS

In the last two issues, we have discovered the charms of a steakhouse in Cumberland and a haute cuisine B&B in Berkeley Springs. This month, we travel across Route 9, then turn north on Route 45 into Shepherdstown. Our destination?

The Yellow Brick Bank

reviewed by Joan Bradfield

Whether you are spending the day exploring Harper's Ferry, "shopping till you drop" in Martinsburg, or just going home, the perfect end to the day would be a trip to the Yellow Brick Bank in Shepherdstown, WV for lunch or dinner. The building itself was truly once a bank. In fact, the old vault now serves as the wine cellar. This is the restaurant that Nancy Reagan and pundit George Will frequented for lunch several times during her stay in the White House.

Food-wise you can't go wrong. The emphasis here is on fresh and seasonal. The dinner menu usually boasts eight or more daily specials. On a recent January visit, the ossa buco was outstanding. Next morning, one of our house-guests was still raving about the pecan crusted rockfish. Jim's paella was chock full of chicken, sausage and an assortment of shell fish. From the regular menu, you will be hard pressed to select from an antipasti of pastrami smoked salmon, or Cuban black bean soup with a side order of sourdough onion rye bread. One of our favorite entrees is the salmon fillet which has been grilled with maple syrup, Dijon mustard, and topped off with a balsamic vinegar glaze. The pasta dishes are also excellent. Try tuna pieces sauteed in olive oil with garlic, sun-dried tomatoes, goat cheese and capers served over linguine, three mushroom pasta or the sinful Gorgonzola cheese over fettucine with sliced pears.

The luncheon menu features some of the same items as the dinner menu, priced slightly lower, along with sandwiches and an assortment of specials..

Reservations are strongly suggested, particularly on weekends or holidays. Be sure to save the little reservation card and when you have collected five, you can exchange them for a bottle of wine.

The Yellow Brick Bank is located at the corner of Routes 45 and 230, just past Shepherd College.

Reservations:
(304)876-2208 or 876-2604

IF YOU HAVE ITEMS, IDEAS, OR ARTICLES FOR THE MOUNTAINSIDE NEWSLETTER

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